increase in students joining from Tier-II and Tier-III cities, enriching classroom diversity and peer perspectives across various management disciplines.

"Some students do face initial challenges, particularly with classroom participation, presentations, and professional communication in English," says Kothari. "However, these challenges are usually transitional rather than indicative of capability. Remedial English and communication support is offered on a need basis."

Regarding recruiter expectations, Kothari notes that while English remains essential for international clients and cross-border teams, corporate criteria are broadening significantly. "In internships and placements, employers ultimately assess a broader set of capabilities, including problem-solving, domain knowledge, teamwork, adaptability, and communication. As organisations expand into Tier-II and Tier-III markets, the ability to understand local contexts and communicate with diverse stakeholders is equally valuable," he says.

BILINGUAL MBA

While Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal's proposal for technology-enabled bilingual management education has sparked widespread debate, academics and corporate leaders emphasise that comparing India to non-English business powerhouses requires careful nuance.

Academics, however, point to practical challenges in implementing bilingual management education across India's many linguistic regions.

"TAPMI admitted students from 25 Indian states," points out Pradhan. "Offering management education in multiple regional languages creates significant logistical challenges, including a lack of economies of scale. Furthermore, we currently do not have the luxury of having world-class textbooks and papers developed by Indian academicians in regional languages."

Rajvanshi echoes the necessity of a common platform for national and international institutes: "Think about a national-level institution that is also an international-level institution. We have overseas students as well. The main communication is in English because otherwise it would be very difficult to bring all the students on the same platform."

Instead of full bilingual degree tracks, educators advocate informal bilingual support to ensure conceptual mastery, coupled with professional English training for workplace readiness.

Kothari explains that a strong bilingual model could use regional languages to explain complex foundational concepts while gradually building the English communication skills required in corporate and international environments. The objective should be accessibility without compromising academic or professional readiness.

Patel of Accord Group India frames this dual approach as two distinct educational goals: a student could master complex financial concepts like discounted cash flow in Hindi or Tamil to ensure absolute conceptual depth, and subsequently learn how to explain those exact findings to an investor in London in clear English.

THE AI SHIFT

The rapid proliferation of artificial intelligence (AI)-powered translation tools and real-time multilingual platforms is altering how companies manage communication and how educational institutes deliver content across regions. At Rassense, employees recently requested internal tools with built-in



"Our hiring approach focuses first on domain knowledge, learning agility, and ambition rather than treating fluency in English as a proxy for competence potential"

DEEPTI SAGAR
CHIEF PEOPLE AND EXPERIENCE OFFICER, DELOITTE INDIA



"Initial challenges are usually transitional rather than indicative of capability. Remedial English and communication support is offered on a need basis"

UMESH KOTHARI
ASSISTANT DEAN, S.P. JAIN SCHOOL OF GLOBAL MANAGEMENT